Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Breakaway Short Stay Service

14-16 Abbey Road, Kenfig Hill, Bridgend, CF33 6HF

01656743295

The inspection visits for this service took place between 09/07/2026 and 10/07/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Bridgend County Borough Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability
Registered places:	6
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Breakaway is a short break service in Kenfig Hill, providing respite care for up to six adults with learning disabilities and a range of additional needs, including autism, physical disabilities, mental health needs, acquired brain injuries and complex needs.

People experience good well-being outcomes. They are supported to make choices about their daily lives, maintain and develop independence and participate in activities that are meaningful to them. Staff know people well, provide effective emotional support and work responsively with families and professionals to promote positive outcomes.

The care and support provided is good. Robust assessment processes ensure staff have a good understanding of people's needs, preferences and risks before support is provided. Care staff use personalised approaches and specialist guidance to provide consistent care, promote positive experiences and support people's health and well-being.

The environment is good. People stay in a safe, accessible and suitable environment that supports their needs. Communal and outdoor spaces promote social interaction, independence and community engagement.

Leadership and management are good. Managers have created a positive and supportive culture where staff feel valued and well supported. Training and development arrangements help staff meet people's changing needs and governance systems provide effective oversight of the service. Managers demonstrate a reflective approach and a commitment to continuous improvement whilst maintaining positive outcomes for people.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People achieve positive well-being outcomes because staff provide care and support that promotes choice, independence and meaningful engagement. We heard from staff of how they provide active support and *“not to take a person’s independence away and encourage them to do as much as they can”.* Relatives describe Breakaway as a much-needed service, highlighting the importance of the respite it provides and the positive difference it makes to both people using the service and their families. One person who accesses short breaks told us *“I love it. I count down the days to come”.*

People have opportunities to influence their daily experiences during short breaks, including choices about activities, meals and routines. Care staff understand people's preferred communication methods and use a range of approaches, including visual supports, prompt cards and technology, to ensure people can express their views and participate in decisions affecting them.

People maintain and develop skills that are important to them. We saw examples of care staff supporting people to increase their independence and confidence. People access opportunities that are meaningful to them, continue attending services that are important in their lives and enjoy a range of community-based and in-house activities. The service also recognises that some people value space to relax and unwind following busy weeks attending day opportunities.

People are supported to maintain relationships that are important to them and can keep in touch with relatives during their short breaks. Relatives spoke positively about the relationships they have with the service. During the inspection, we observed a coffee morning which brought families together to socialise, share their experiences and provide feedback to help shape the ongoing development of the service. People also benefit from opportunities to access short breaks alongside friends, helping them maintain important relationships and enjoy shared experiences.

Care staff know people well and provide effective support with their physical, emotional and mental well-being. They recognise when people need reassurance and encouragement and respond in ways which reduce anxiety and promote positive experiences. We heard several examples of staff providing valuable support during periods of difficulty for people and their families, resulting in improved well-being outcomes.

People are protected by staff who understand their safeguarding responsibilities and respond appropriately and promptly to any concerns about safety or well-being. Relatives told us they have confidence in the service and feel able to raise queries or concerns.

People stay in an environment that supports their well-being during short breaks. The service provides comfortable accommodation, opportunities to socialise with others and spaces where people can relax and unwind. The provider recognises there are opportunities to further enhance the homely feel of the environment and has identified areas for ongoing improvement.

Care & Support — Good

People receive good quality care and support because the provider completes thorough assessments before offering a service. Care staff gather relevant information from a range of sources, including referral documentation, care and support needs assessments, families, day opportunities, case managers, health professionals and their own observations. Managers also consider the compatibility of people accessing the service during the pre-admission process and when planning respite stays. People have opportunities to visit the service before their stay. Professionals told us the service takes time to learn about people's likes, dislikes and interests to help them feel comfortable and reduce anxieties.

Care staff know the people they support well and provide consistent, responsive care. People's care and support plans benefit from detailed supplementary assessments and specialist information. Personal information, communication guidance and behavioural support strategies help care staff provide consistent support and understand what matters to people. Managers identify opportunities to strengthen arrangements further by reviewing care plans prior to each respite stay, helping to ensure staff have the most up-to-date information about people's needs, preferences and any changes in circumstances. One person told us, "*The staff know me well and they know what I like*". We observed a knowledgeable and committed staff team who demonstrate a good understanding of people's individual needs, preferences and routines.

Medication is managed safely through organised systems, audits and staff competency checks. Clear processes support safe administration and oversight. Care staff recognise changes in people's health and wellbeing and take appropriate action when concerns arise. Effective communication with relatives and liaison with health and social care professionals helps ensure people receive timely interventions and appropriate support.

People's risk of infection is minimised through effective infection prevention and control practices. The home has achieved a Food Standards Agency rating of 5 (very good). We observed adequate supplies of personal protective equipment (PPE) and suitable cleaning equipment throughout the service. Staff receive appropriate training and maintain communal areas to a good standard of cleanliness. As people access the service for short-term respite stays, staff ensure bedrooms and associated equipment are cleaned and sanitised between admissions to promote a safe and hygienic environment.

Environment — Good

Breakaway consists of a pair of semi-detached houses located within the local community, which have been joined and extended over time to provide a safe, accessible, and homely environment. Accommodation is available on both the ground and first floors. The ground floor includes a fully adapted bedroom and bathroom suite to meet the needs of people with reduced mobility. A lift is available to provide access between floors; however, at the time of the inspection, it had been out of service for over six months. We found this does not impact people's ability to access respite stays, as suitable ground-floor accommodation is available and staff ensure people's needs can continue to be met safely.

People stay in an environment that is safe, suitable and supports their needs. There are spacious communal areas that promote social interaction and enable care staff to provide support while maintaining oversight across different areas of the home. A second lounge area provides people with the option of spending time in a quieter space if they wish. Facilities are accessible and support people with a range of mobility and support needs to move around the service safely and comfortably. The service benefits from a large, accessible outdoor area that offers opportunities for relaxation, recreation and social engagement. As a respite service, the environment is organised to ensure people can settle in comfortably during their stay and access the facilities that best meet their individual needs.

The environment is secure. The provider completes a range of environmental checks and maintenance systems help identify and manage risks. We saw evidence of an ongoing programme of servicing for facilities and utilities, with regular safety checks completed. Records showed routine testing of equipment and utilities is undertaken. Care staff complete fire safety checks and fire drills regularly, and personal emergency evacuation plans provide clear guidance on how people should be supported safely in an emergency.

The home is clean and tidy, with adequate space and storage available. Whilst the environment is safe and suitable for people using the service, some areas would benefit from refurbishment and modernisation. We noted worn flooring in places, and the entrance area was relatively small, leading into a long corridor with limited natural light. This resulted in a less welcoming first impression of the service. The provider was aware of these areas for improvement and had identified actions through its quality assurance processes to refresh and enhance the environment, and creates a more welcoming atmosphere for people accessing respite care.

Leadership & Management — Good

People are supported by a motivated staff team who work within a positive and supportive culture. Care staff told us they enjoy their roles, feel valued and take pride in making a difference to people's lives. One person told us, *"this is the best job I've had – it's like a family"*. Staff morale is good, and managers are highly regarded by the team, with the service's manager being described as *"caring"*, *"supportive"* and that you *"couldn't ask for better".*

Safe recruitment processes are in place, including appropriate pre-employment checks and Social Care Wales registration requirements. The provider maintains staffing levels that enable people's needs to be met safely and consistently. Care staff are supported to develop the skills and knowledge needed for their roles through effective induction, training, supervision and ongoing development opportunities.

The provider has established governance and quality assurance systems that provide effective oversight of the service. The manager has oversight of all aspects of care provided in the home. The Responsible Individual (RI) visits the home on a quarterly basis and seeks feedback from people using the service, their representatives and care staff. This feedback is considered alongside a range of audits, including environmental and care practice audits, to monitor the quality and safety of the service. The findings are brought together within a biannual Quality of Care Report, which highlights areas of good practice and identifies opportunities for further development and improvement. Team meetings take place regularly and provide opportunities for communication, reflection and shared learning. Care staff receive regular supervision and opportunities to discuss their practice, development and training needs.

Managers demonstrate a reflective approach and recognise areas where practice and systems can be strengthened further. They have led the service through a period of significant workforce change and have taken proactive steps to recruit and develop new staff while maintaining continuity of care for people using the service. Policies and procedures are managed at an organisational level across Bridgend County Borough Council services and provide care staff with clear guidance on how to support people safely and respectfully. We found some policies are overdue for review, although the provider has recognised this and taken steps to address it. A designated member of staff has recently been appointed to lead the review of policies and procedures, and we saw evidence of a clear action plan being developed to support this work.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

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